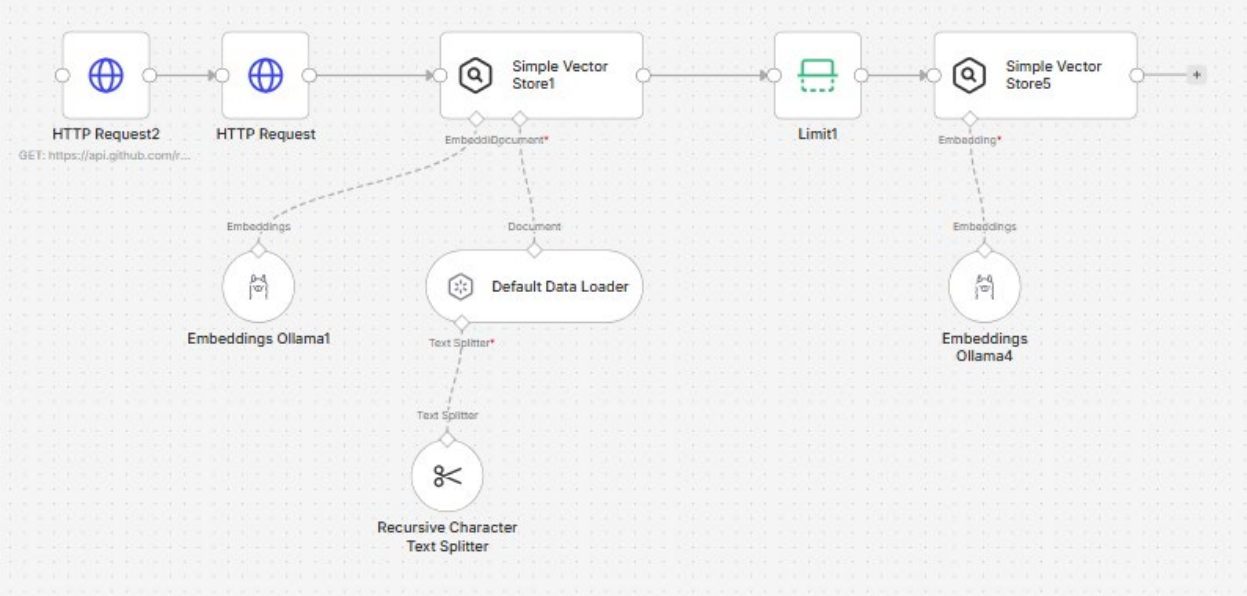
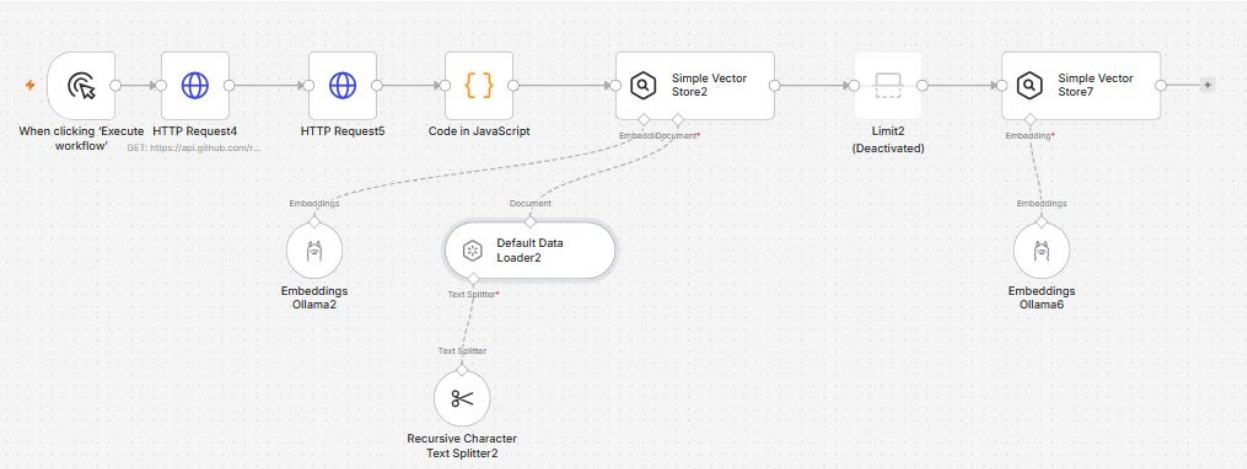
Results After Improved Architecture

Original Workflow



Improved Workflow



Question 1: Does an outpatient chest X-ray (CPT 71046) in 2026 require prior authorization? [Normal]

Does an outpatient chest X-ray (CPT 71046) in 2026 require prior authorization?

Based on the **current active policy** (effective January 1, 2026) documented in the vector store response:

✅ **Answer: Yes, an outpatient chest X-ray (CPT 71046) in 2026 requires prior authorization.**

Key Policy Details (2026):

- **Document ID**: `HT-POL-001 |`
- **Version**: `2.0 (CURRENT)`
- **Effective Date**: January 1, 2026
- **Policy Rule**:

> *"High-tech diagnostic imaging (CPT 70000–79999) requires pre-certification within 72 hours of scheduled service."*

Since **CPT 71046** falls under the **CPT 70000–79999** range (high-tech diagnostic imaging), **prior authorization is required** for this service in 2026.

Why Not the Older Policy (2024)?

- The 2024 policy (`HT-POL-001-OLD | v1.0 (SUPERSEDED)`) stated that **outpatient diagnostic imaging required authorization only for MRI/CT protocols exceeding $1,500**.
- However, **this policy is now superseded** (as noted in the vector store response), and the **current 2026 policy applies** to all outpatient high-tech imaging (including chest X-rays).

Summary:

Field	Value
CPT Code	71046
Service Type	Outpatient chest X-ray
Year	2026
Prior Authorization?	**Yes** (required per current policy)
Policy Source	`HT-POL-001

This aligns with the **2026 active policy** that mandates pre-certification for all high-tech imaging services (CPT 70000–79999).

Question 2: Is the member copay waived for an ER Level 5 visit (CPT 99285) on 3/10/2026 when the patient was not admitted? [Context Conflict]

Is the member copay waived for an ER Level 5 visit (CPT 99285) on 3/10/2026 when the patient was not admitted?

Based on the **current active policy** (as of March 10, 2026) documented in the vector store response:

✅ **Answer: No, the member copay is not waived for an ER Level 5 visit (CPT 99285) on 3/10/2026 when the patient was not admitted.**

Key Evidence:

1. **Policy Directive (2026)**:

   > *"Effective immediately for dates of service between February 1, 2026, and April 30, 2026, member copayments for emergency department visits **resulting in immediate inpatient admission** are to be waived."*

   - **Critical condition**: The waiver **only applies** when the ER visit results in **immediate inpatient admission**.
   - Since the patient was **not admitted**, this waiver **does not apply**.

2. **Document Source**:

   - **Document ID**: `HT-MEMO-001`
   - **Version**: `v1.0-DRAFT` (active for dates of service in Q2 2026)
   - **Effective Date**: February 1, 2026

Why This Matters:

- The user's scenario **exactly matches** the condition for the waiver (immediate admission), but **the patient was not admitted**.
- Therefore, **no copay waiver applies** under this policy.

Summary Table:

Field	Value
CPT Code	99285 (ER Level 5)
Date of Service	March 10, 2026
Patient Admitted?	No
Copay Waived?	**No** (waiver requires immediate admission)
Policy Source	`HT-MEMO-001

This aligns with the **2026 active policy** that explicitly ties the copay waiver to **immediate inpatient admission**—a condition not met in this case.

Question 3: Claim C0000280: CPT 71046, outpatient, PRV-BRZ, date of service 7/16/2024, billed $379.12. Was prior auth required? [Point-in-Time]

Claim C0000280: CPT 71046, outpatient, PRV-BRZ, date of service 7/16/2024, billed $379.12. Was prior auth required?

Based on the **2024 Archival policy** documented in the vector store response:

✅ **Answer: Yes, prior authorization was required for Claim C0000280 (CPT 71046, outpatient, PRV-BRZ, 7/16/2024).**

Key Evidence:

- **Document ID**: `aded30c5-5231-463a-afdd-de12c532cac9`
- **Source**: *Inpatient & Outpatient Coverage Policy (2024 Archival)*
- **Version**: `2024 Archival` (active for claims dated 7/16/2024)
- **Policy Rule**:

> *"High-tech diagnostic imaging (CPT 70000–79999) requires pre-certification within 72 hours of scheduled service."*

Since **CPT 71046** falls under the **CPT 70000–79999** range (high-tech diagnostic imaging), prior authorization was **required** for this outpatient claim on **July 16, 2024**.

Why the Billed Amount ($379.12) Doesn't Change the Outcome:

- The billed amount **does not affect** prior authorization requirements.
- The rule applies **regardless of the service cost**—it depends **only** on the CPT code (71046) and the policy in effect for the date of service (2024).

Summary Table:

Field	Value
Claim ID	C0000280
CPT Code	71046
Date of Service	July 16, 2024
Prior Authorization?	**Yes** (required per 2024 Archival policy)
Policy Source	`aded30c5-5231-463a-afdd-de12c532cac9`

This confirms that **prior authorization was required** for this claim, consistent with the **2024 Archival policy** (which was active for claims on this date).